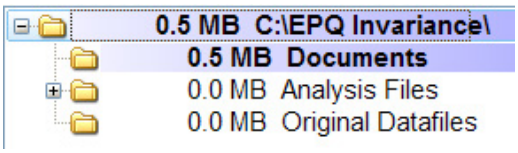
EPQ Cross-Cultural Archive – Design Information #1

December 18th, 2008

Proposed Archival File Structure and details

The root directories are:

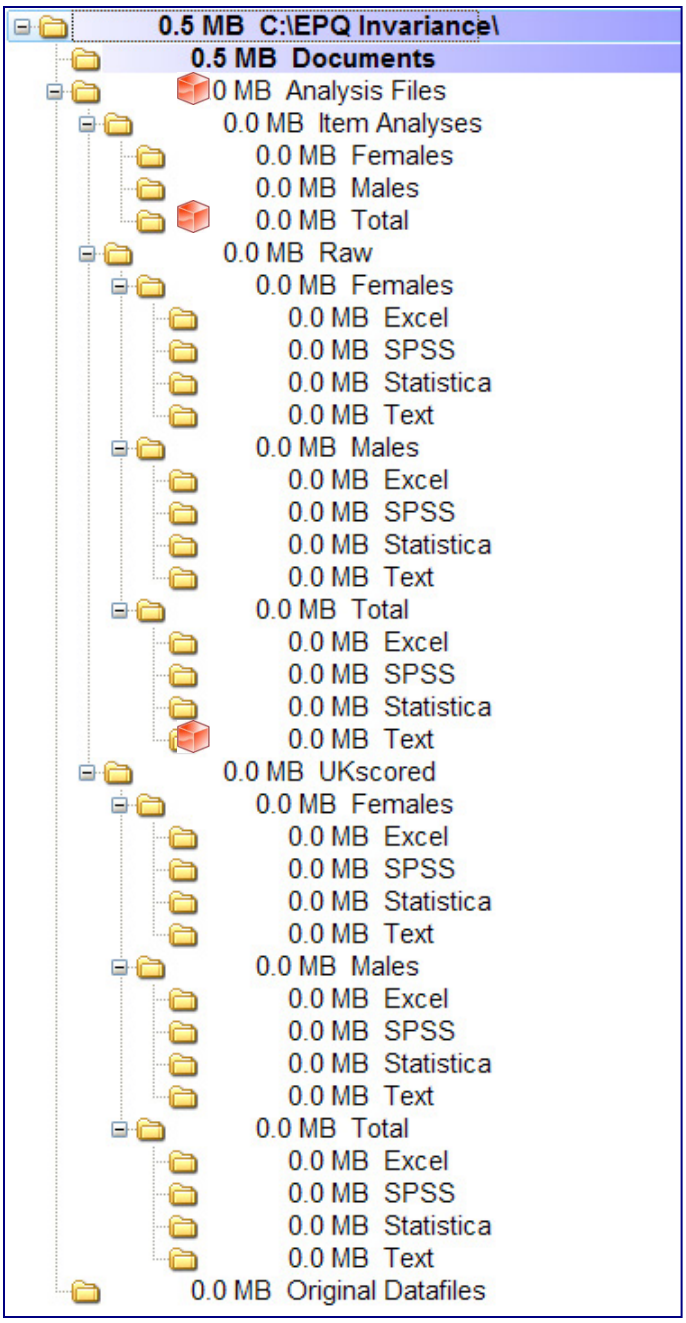


The *Documents* subdirectory contains the EPQ 90-item questionnaire text, the available fUK and foreign dataset scorekeys, and ancillary summary information pertaining to the entire dataset, including notes, and summary tables describing features of the datasets.

The *Analysis Files* subdirectory contains all the files available for analysis work.

The *Original Datafiles* subdirectory contains the original Institute of Psychiatry datafiles (from card and tape sources)

The complete subdirectory map is:



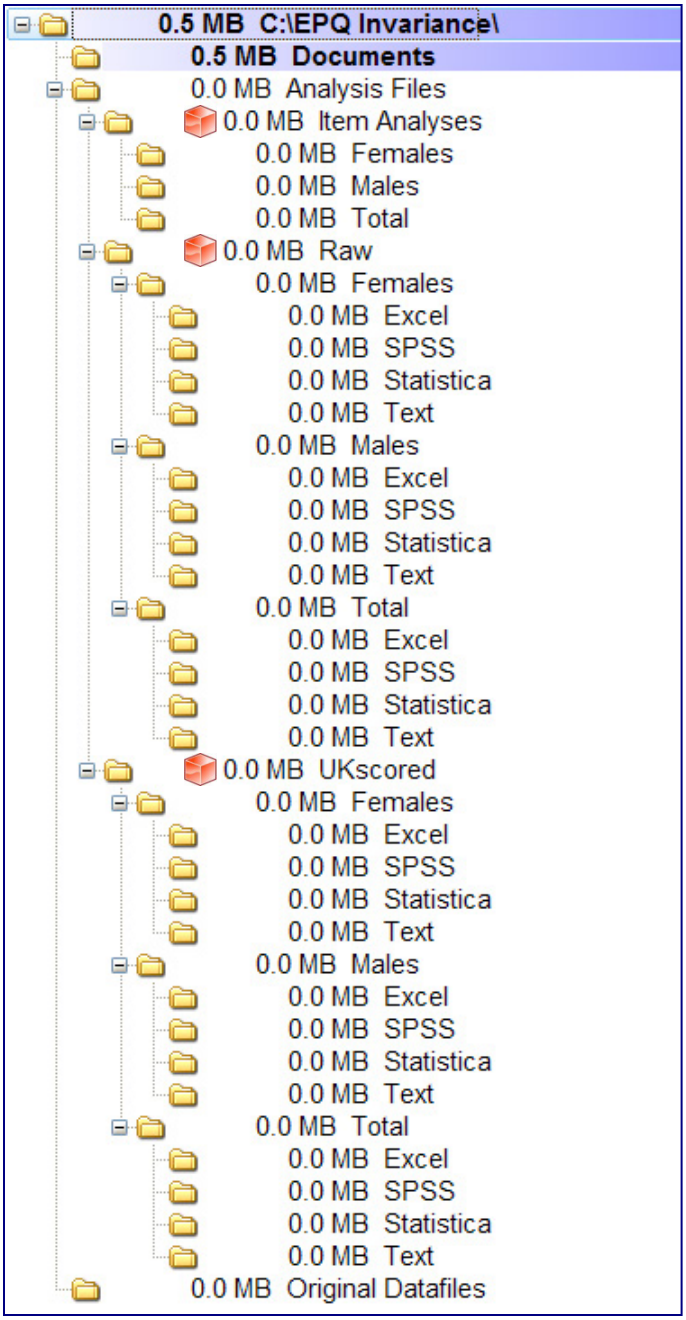
The *Item Analyses* subdirectory contains the output scale descriptives and comprehensive item-analysis results for every country dataset, subdivided into male, females, and total sample results. These results are run using my SCORER and ITEMAN programs, with result output as formatted ASCII text files. These two routines also provide as output, the scale order, item-labeled, scored item files which can be converted to SPSS and other formats.

The results outputs are there as helpful "verification" analyses for those who might wish to undertake their own kinds of scoring and item analyses. I'm using the UK score key for every file – as we don't have access to every unique country scorekey. Those we do will be listed and presented in full in the *Documents* subdirectory.

The *Raw* subdirectory of the *Analysis Files* Subdirectory contains the unscored, formatted datafiles for every country, subdivided into *Males*, *Females*, and *Total* subdirectories. Each file contains the 90 items of the EPQ, in standard UK questionnaire order. Each gender subdirectory contains the questionnaire data in 4 file formats (again, a separate subdirectory has been allocated to hold each format file – Excel (.xls), SPSS (.sav), STATISTICA (.sta), and .csv format plain-text).

Each file contains Subject ID, Age, Gender, and the 90 items (labeled).

Item response codes are 1 and 3, (3 for Yes and 1 for No). A '2' was sometimes allocated for a missing or unintelligible response.



The *UKscored* subdirectory contains the same directory structure as the *Raw* subdirectory.

Each file contains Subject ID, Age, Gender, and the 90 items (labeled).

Item response codes are now a 0, 1 (1 = response in keyed direction). Any '2' responses are patched in as a '0', and indentified case by case in the Item Analysis output subdirectory. However, strict quality control by Sybil in the data acquisition process meant very few missing responses existed in any dataset, as only records containing at least 95% valid responses were originally retained for analysis.

In all, the archive will consist of 840 datafiles, with 105 analysis output files.

These files will be created and stored in the predesigned locations via batch automation using a mixture of Delphi and Fortran programs.